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EFFECT OF DISCOUNTS AND OFFERS ON CUSTOMER PURCHASE INTENTION

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ABSTRACT:

The proliferation of discounts and promotional offers in modern retailing has transformed the landscape of consumer decision-making, creating new dynamics in how customers perceive, evaluate, and respond to pricing strategies. This research paper investigates the effect of discounts and promotional offers on customer purchase intention, examining both the psychological triggers and behavioural outcomes of promotional pricing strategies. A descriptive research design was adopted using primary data collected through a structured Google Forms questionnaire distributed among 61 respondents. The study examines consumer attitudes toward discounts across five Likert-scale statements, ten multiple-choice knowledge and perception questions, and ten behavioural Yes/No questions, providing a comprehensive picture of how discounts influence purchase intentions at cognitive, attitudinal, and behavioural levels. The findings reveal that 80% of respondents agree that discounts encourage unplanned purchases, 75% confirm that limited-time offers accelerate purchase decisions, and 69% habitually wait for sales before buying, one of the strongest behavioural indicators in the study. While 66% acknowledge that discounts positively influence brand perception, an equal proportion (66%) also report that discounts affect their perception of product quality, highlighting the double-edged nature of aggressive promotional pricing. The paper concludes that discounts and offers are highly effective tools for stimulating purchase intention, increasing basket size, and accelerating decision-making. However, businesses must strategically balance promotional frequency with brand equity preservation, as excessive discounting risks reducing perceived product quality and undermining long-term consumer loyalty.

Keywords: Discounts, Purchase Intention, Promotional Offers, Consumer Behaviour, Brand Perception, Price Sensitivity

1. INTRODUCTION

1.1 Background of the Study

Discounts and promotional offers have become ubiquitous features of modern retail and ecommerce environments. From seasonal sales and flash deals to loyalty rewards and bundle offers, businesses across all sectors employ promotional pricing as a core strategy to attract consumers, increase sales volumes, and compete in increasingly crowded marketplaces. The global rise of e-commerce platforms has intensified this trend, with platforms like Amazon, Flipkart, and Meesho running continuous promotional campaigns that have conditioned consumers to expect and actively seek discounts before committing to a purchase.

Consumer purchase intention the degree to which a consumer is prepared and motivated to make a purchase is one of the most studied constructs in marketing research. It represents the critical link between consumer attitudes and actual buying behaviour. Understanding the factors that influence purchase intention is therefore of paramount importance for marketers, brand managers, and retail strategists.

Discounts influence purchase intention through multiple psychological and economic pathways. At the economic level, lower prices increase the perceived value proposition of a product, making it more attractive relative to alternatives. At the psychological level, discounts trigger cognitive mechanisms such as scarcity perception, loss aversion, and FOMO (Fear of Missing Out), which create urgency and reduce purchase hesitation. At the social level, promotional offers can signal smart shopping behaviour and social status, adding an additional motivation layer.

1.2 Research Problem

While the impact of discounts on consumer behaviour has been studied extensively in Western consumer markets, research examining how Indian consumers particularly young, digitally active consumers respond to discount strategies remains relatively limited. Furthermore, most existing studies focus on individual dimensions of discount effects rather than providing an integrated view that covers cognitive, attitudinal, perceptual, and behavioural dimensions simultaneously. This study seeks to fill this gap.

1.3 Objectives of the Study

The objectives of this research are as follows:

- To examine the influence of discounts and promotional offers on consumer purchase intentions and buying behaviour
- To identify the psychological factors triggered by discount strategies among consumers
- To assess how different types of promotional offers create varying levels of urgency and engagement
- To investigate the impact of discounts on consumer perceptions of product quality and brand value
- To analyze the long-term relationship between discount strategies and customer loyalty

- To provide strategic recommendations for businesses seeking to optimize their promotional pricing approaches

1.4 Scope and Significance of the Study

This study is significant for several reasons. First, it provides empirical evidence on the multidimensional effects of discounts on Indian consumers, offering insights that are directly applicable to Indian retail and e-commerce businesses. Second, it examines both positive and potentially negative consequences of discount strategies, providing a balanced perspective that is often absent from purely promotional marketing literature. Third, it contributes to the broader academic understanding of price promotion effects within the consumer behaviour discipline.

The study focuses on management students and working professionals in India, with particular relevance to the 18–35 age demographic that constitutes the most active online shopping population and is most frequently targeted by promotional marketing campaigns.

2. LITERATURE REVIEW WITH RESEARCH GAP

The academic literature on promotional pricing and consumer purchase behaviour is extensive, spanning multiple disciplines including marketing, consumer psychology, behavioural economics, and retail management.

Kotler and Keller (2016) identified price promotion as one of the most powerful short-term tools available to marketers for stimulating demand. They noted that promotional pricing works through both rational (economic savings) and irrational (psychological triggers) pathways, making it effective across a wide range of consumer segments and product categories.

Research by Blattberg and Neslin (1990) established the foundational framework for understanding price promotions, demonstrating that discounts consistently generate above-average purchase rates by accelerating purchase timing, increasing purchase quantity, and attracting brand switchers. Their work confirmed that promotional pricing has a direct and measurable positive effect on short-term sales volumes.

Zeithaml (1988) introduced the concept of perceived value as a central mediating variable between price and purchase intention. According to Zeithaml's framework, consumers do not respond to price per se but to the perceived ratio of quality received to price paid. Discounts influence purchase intention by improving this ratio either by reducing the price while maintaining perceived quality, or by creating a reference price anchor that makes the discounted price appear significantly more valuable.

Kahneman and Tversky's (1979) Prospect Theory provides the most widely cited psychological explanation for discount effectiveness. Under Prospect Theory, consumers evaluate outcomes relative to a reference point and are more sensitive to losses than to equivalent gains. A discount can be framed as avoiding a loss (paying full price), making it psychologically more compelling than an equivalent absolute price reduction.

Research on scarcity and urgency by Cialdini (2001) demonstrated that limited-time and limited-quantity offers trigger the psychological principle of scarcity, dramatically increasing purchase urgency and

reducing deliberation time. This mechanism explains why flash sales and countdown-timer promotions are particularly effective at converting browsing behaviour into purchase behaviour.

Stiving and Winer (1997) examined the negative quality signal effect of discounting, finding that in certain product categories particularly those where quality is difficult to assess before purchase consumers infer lower product quality from discounted prices. This finding has significant implications for premium brands considering discount strategies.

Research Gap

Despite extensive international literature on promotional pricing effects, several research gaps motivate this study. First, most existing research focuses on a single dimension of discount effects (e.g., purchase quantity or brand switching) rather than providing an integrated view covering cognitive, attitudinal, perceptual, and behavioural dimensions simultaneously. Second, limited primary research examines the specific response patterns of Indian consumers particularly young, digitally-active consumers to diverse discount formats including seasonal sales, BOGO offers, and limited-time deals. Third, the relationship between discount frequency and product quality perception in the Indian e-commerce context has received insufficient empirical attention. This study addresses all three gaps through comprehensive primary data collection and analysis.

3. DATA COLLECTION AND RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

3.1 Research Design

This study adopts a descriptive research design to examine consumer attitudes, perceptions, and behaviours relating to discounts and promotional offers. Descriptive research is appropriate because it allows for systematic data collection about current consumer experiences and attitudes without manipulation of variables.

3.2 Research Approach

A quantitative research approach was employed using a structured questionnaire with Likertscale, multiple-choice, and dichotomous (Yes/No) question formats. This approach enables standardized, comparable measurement of consumer perceptions and behavioural intentions across a representative sample.

3.3 Data Sources

Primary Data: Collected through a structured Google Forms questionnaire distributed among 61 respondents. The instrument covered attitudinal statements, knowledge and perception questions, and behavioural self-report questions.

Secondary Data: Academic journals, marketing textbooks, consumer behaviour research, retail industry reports, and previously published studies on promotional pricing and purchase intention.

3.4 Sampling Technique

Convenience sampling was employed, allowing for efficient data collection from accessible and willing respondents. The sample included management students and working professionals with regular e-commerce and retail shopping experience.

3.5 Sample Size

A total of 61 respondents participated in the study, providing a sufficient sample for descriptive analysis of consumer behaviour patterns related to discount and promotional pricing strategies.

3.6 Data Collection Instrument

A structured questionnaire comprising 25 questions organized in three sections was used. Section A (Q1-Q5): Five Likert-scale attitudinal statements measuring core discountpurchase intention relationships. Section B (Q6-Q15): Ten multiple-choice questions assessing consumer knowledge, perceptions, and understanding of discount mechanisms. Section C (Q16-Q25): Ten behavioural Yes/No questions capturing actual self-reported discount-related purchasing behaviours.

3.7 Data Analysis Techniques

Responses were analyzed using descriptive statistical techniques including frequency distribution and percentage analysis. All findings are presented in tabular format with interpretations. The three-section structure enables a holistic analysis spanning attitudinal, perceptual, and behavioural dimensions of the discount-purchase intention relationship.

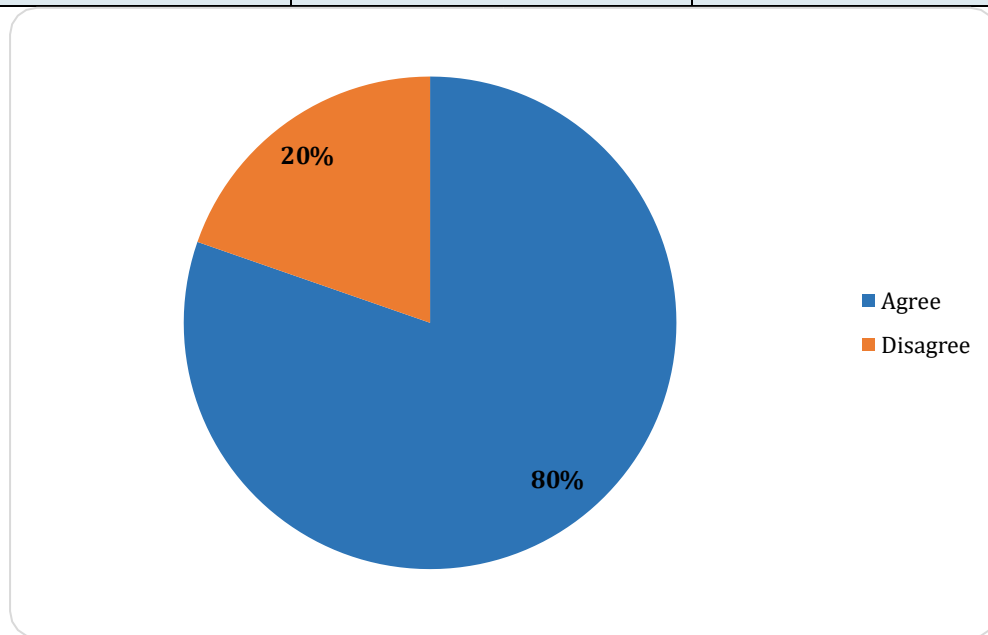
3.8 Conceptual Research Model

The conceptual model of this study proposes that discount and promotional offer strategies influence purchase intention through three pathways: (1) Attitudinal influence by changing how positively consumers feel about a product or brand; (2) Perceptual influence by affecting how consumers evaluate value, quality, and urgency; and (3) Behavioural influence by directly triggering observable purchasing behaviours such as increased basket size, brand switching, and deferred purchasing until promotional events occur. The model acknowledges that these effects may be moderated by price sensitivity, brand loyalty, and discount frequency.

4.1 DATA ANALYSIS AND FINDINGS

1. Discounts encourage me to purchase products I would not normally buy.

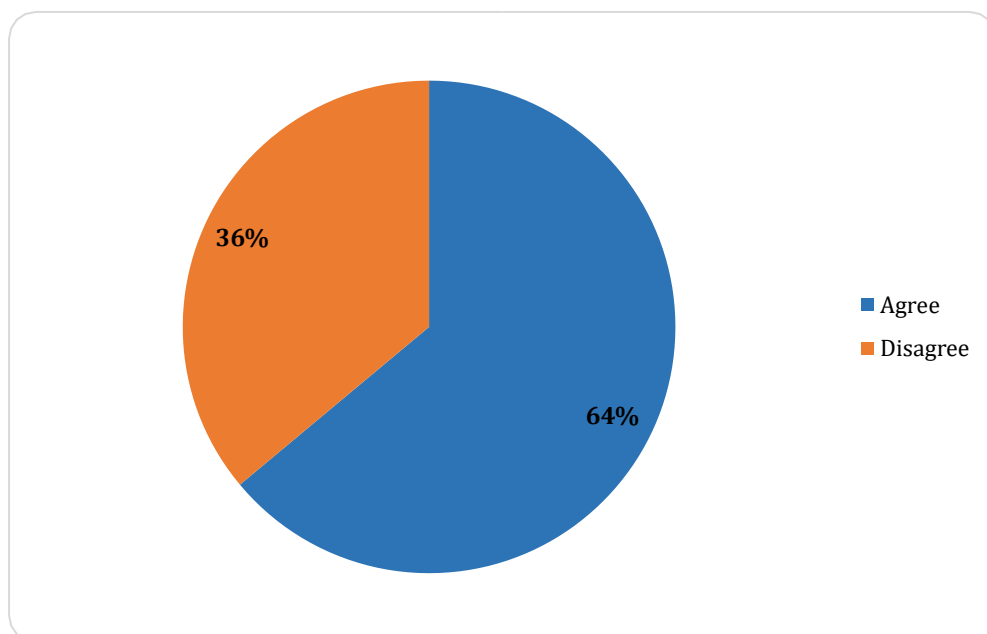
Response	No. of Respondents	Percentage
Agree	49	80%
Disagree	12	20%
Total	61	100%



Interpretation: 80% of respondents agreed that discounts encourage them to purchase products they would not normally buy, while 20% disagreed. This finding strongly confirms that discounts act as a powerful trigger for impulse and unplanned purchasing behaviour, expanding the typical scope of consumer buying decisions.

2. I tend to spend more money when discounts or offers are available.

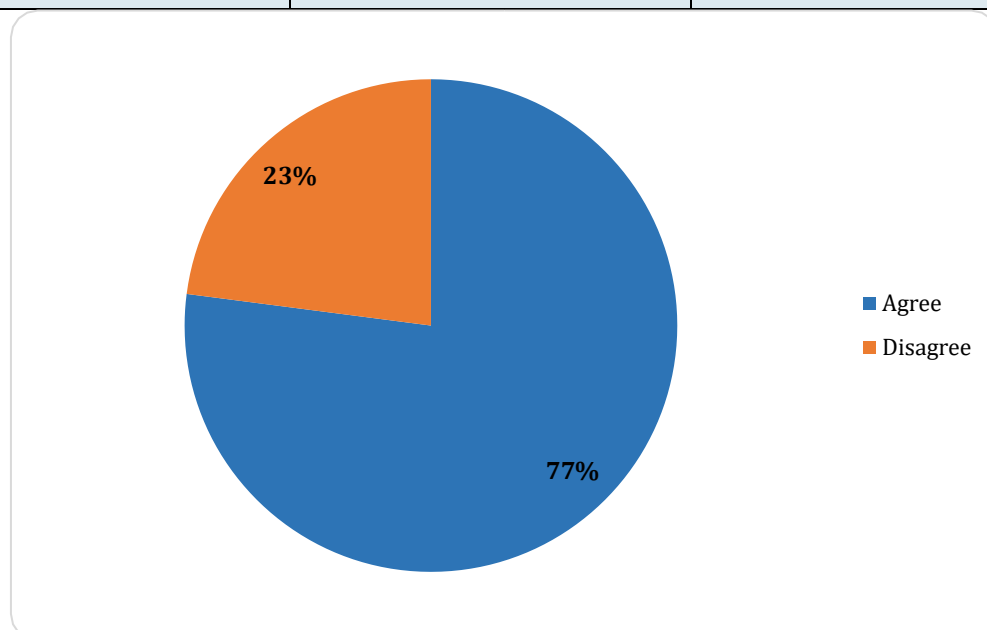
Response	No. of Respondents	Percentage
Agree	39	64%
Disagree	22	36%
Total	61	100%



Interpretation: 64% of respondents agreed that they tend to spend more when discounts or offers are available, while 36% disagreed. This indicates that promotional pricing has a direct and positive influence on total consumer expenditure, making discounts an effective tool for increasing average transaction value.

3. I am more likely to choose a brand if it offers special promotions or deals.

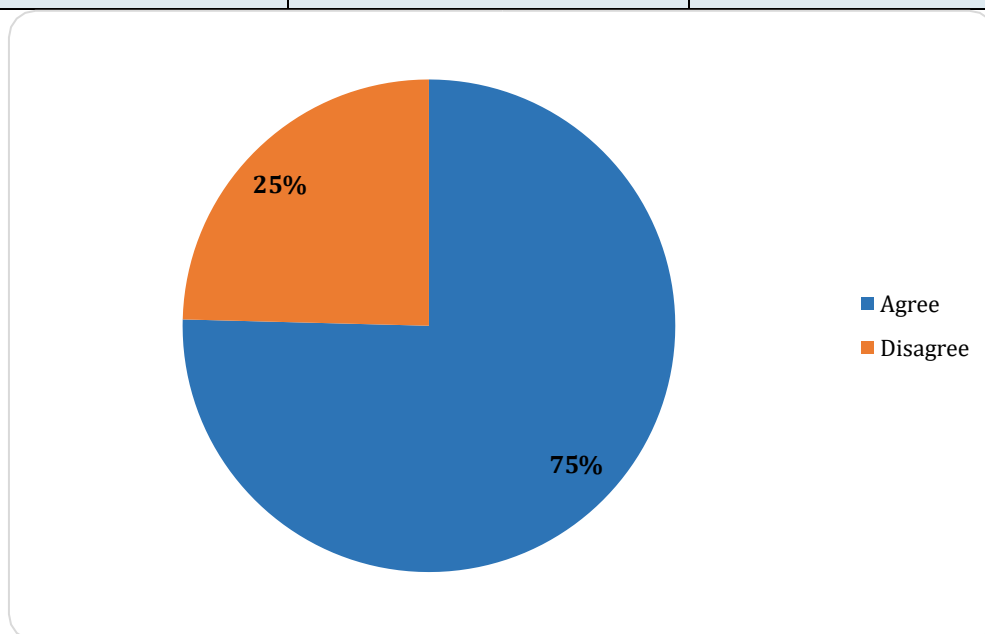
Response	No. of Respondents	Percentage
Agree	47	77%
Disagree	14	23%
Total	61	100%



Interpretation: 77% of respondents are more likely to choose a brand that offers special promotions, while 23% are not. This demonstrates that discount strategies play a significant role in brand selection and competitive differentiation, particularly in markets where multiple brands offer similar products.

4. Limited-time offers increase my urgency to make a purchase decision.

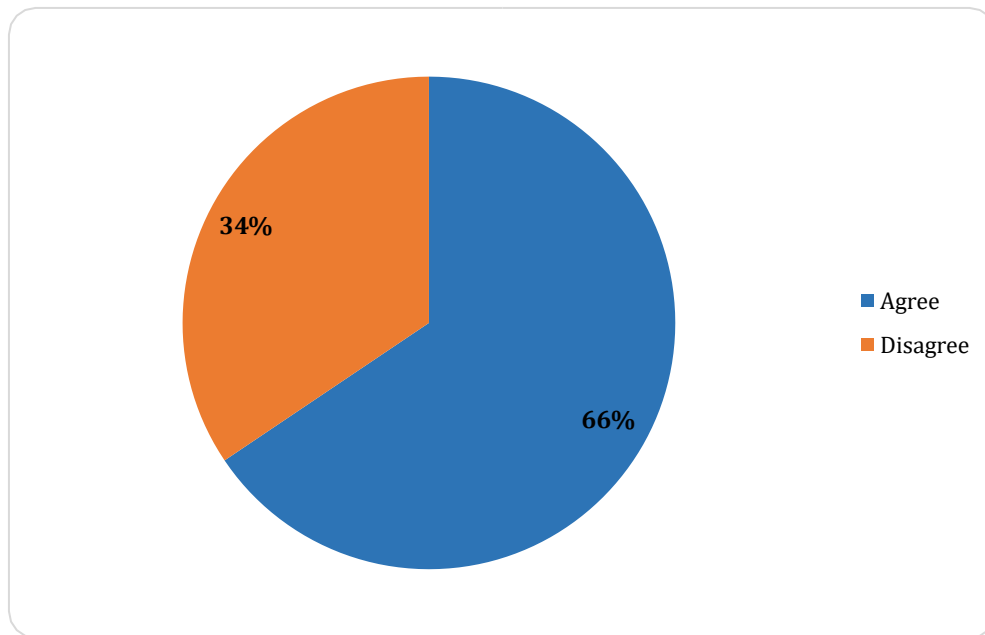
Response	No. of Respondents	Percentage
Agree	46	75%
Disagree	15	25%
Total	61	100%



Interpretation: 75% of respondents agreed that limited-time offers increase their urgency to purchase, while 25% disagreed. This finding supports the psychological principle of scarcity and FOMO (Fear of Missing Out), confirming that time-restricted promotions are highly effective at accelerating purchase decision-making.

5. Discounts and offers positively influence my overall perception of a product or brand.

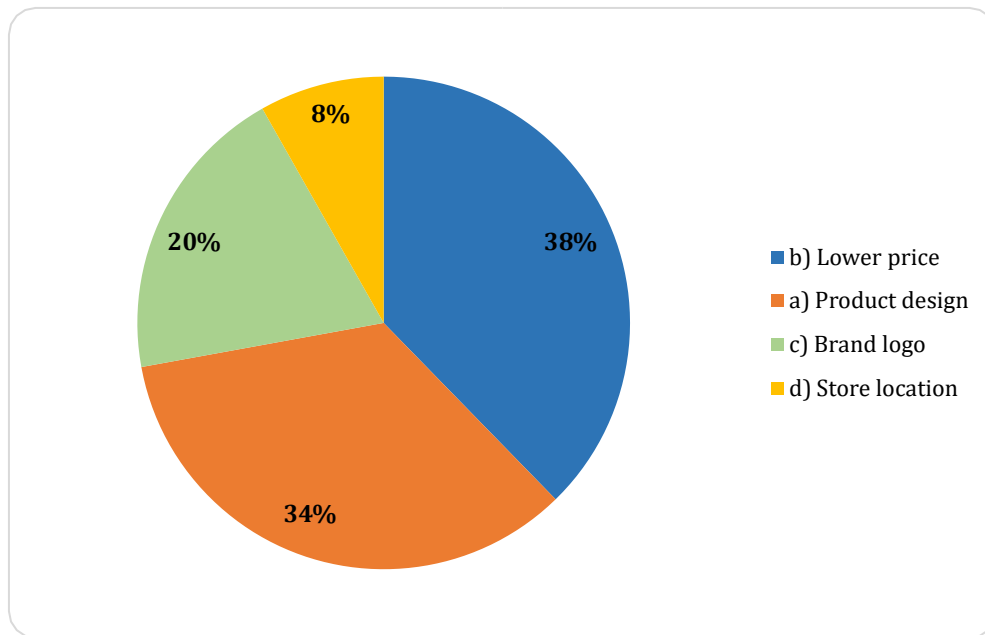
Response	No. of Respondents	Percentage
Agree	40	66%
Disagree	21	34%
Total	61	100%



Interpretation: 66% of respondents agreed that discounts positively influence their perception of a product or brand, while 34% disagreed. While the majority view discounts favourably, the 34% who disagree suggests that heavy discounting can sometimes raise concerns about product quality or brand prestige among a notable segment of consumers.

6. What is the main reason customers are attracted to discounts?

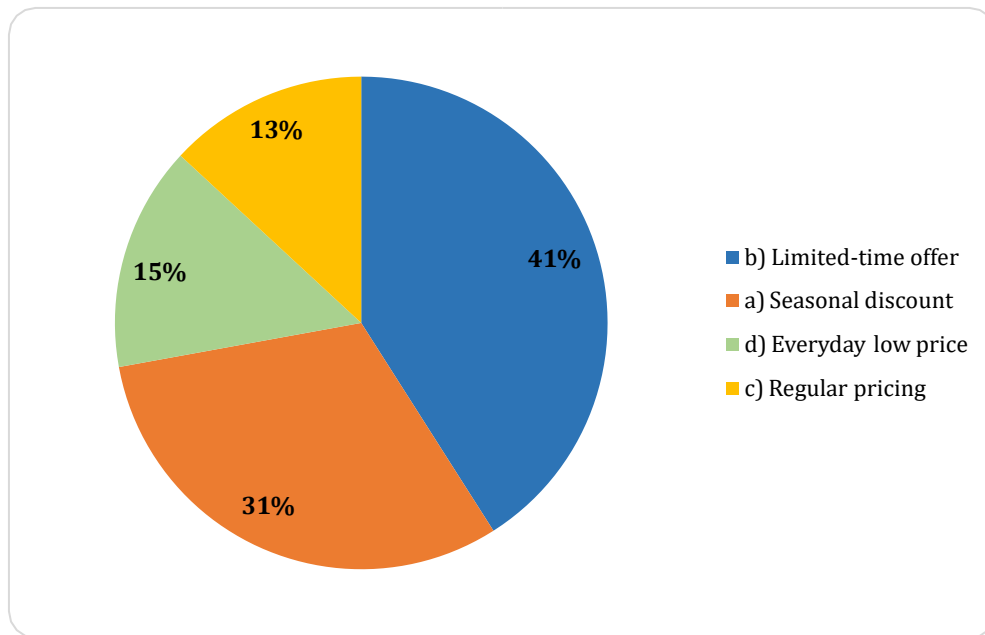
Response	No. of Respondents	Percentage
b) Lower price	23	38%
a) Product design	21	34%
c) Brand logo	12	20%
d) Store location	5	8%
Total	61	100%



Interpretation: 38% of respondents identified lower price as the primary reason customers are attracted to discounts, followed by product design at 34%. Brand logo (20%) and store location (8%) were less frequently cited. This confirms that price sensitivity is the dominant motivator behind discount-driven purchasing behaviour.

7. Which type of offer creates urgency in customers?

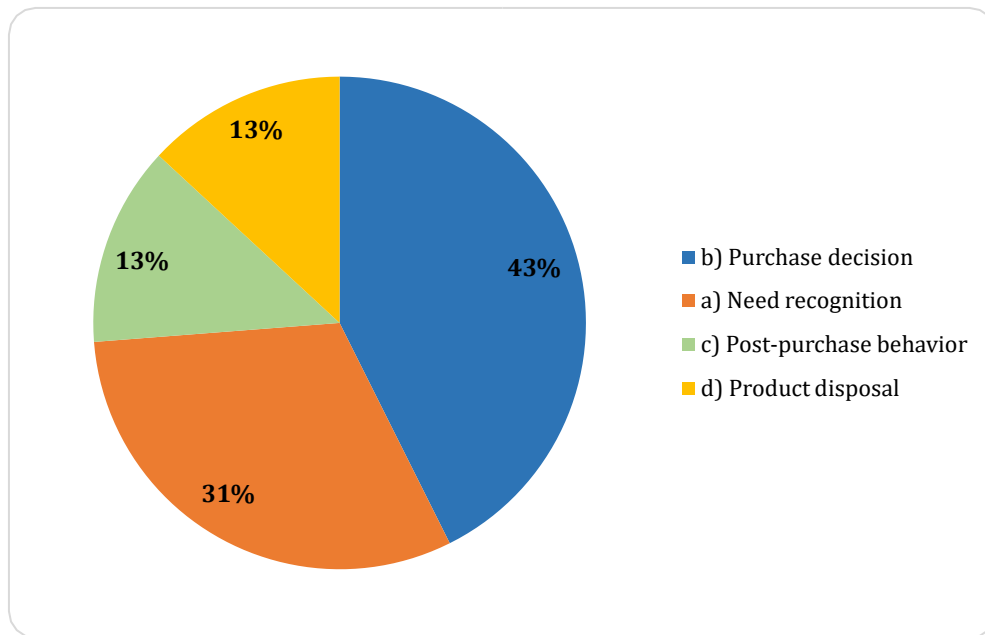
Response	No. of Respondents	Percentage
b) Limited-time offer	25	41%
a) Seasonal discount	19	31%
d) Everyday low price	9	15%
c) Regular pricing	8	13%
Total	61	100%



Interpretation: 41% of respondents identified limited-time offers as the most urgency-inducing promotion, followed by seasonal discounts at 31%. Everyday low pricing (15%) and regular pricing (13%) ranked lower, confirming that time scarcity is the key psychological mechanism through which offers drive rapid purchase decisions.

8. Discounts mainly influence which stage of buying behavior?

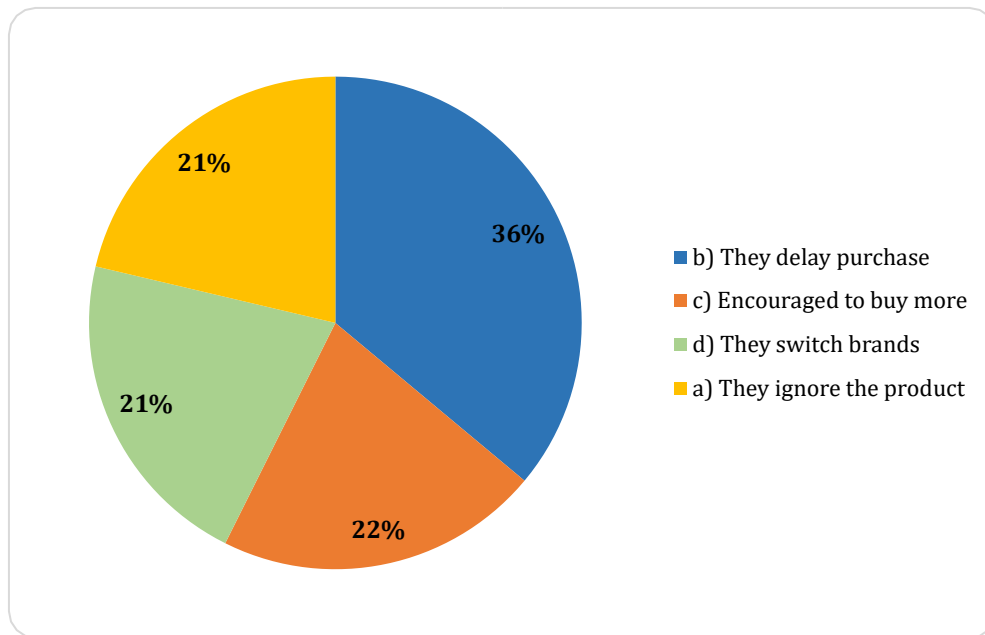
Response	No. of Respondents	Percentage
b) Purchase decision	26	43%
a) Need recognition	19	31%
c) Post-purchase behavior	8	13%
d) Product disposal	8	13%
Total	61	100%



Interpretation: 43% of respondents indicated that discounts primarily influence the purchase decision stage of the buying process, while 31% identified need recognition. Post-purchase behaviour and product disposal each accounted for 13%. This highlights that discounts are most powerful at the critical moment of conversion.

9. What happens when customers see "Buy One Get One Free" offers?

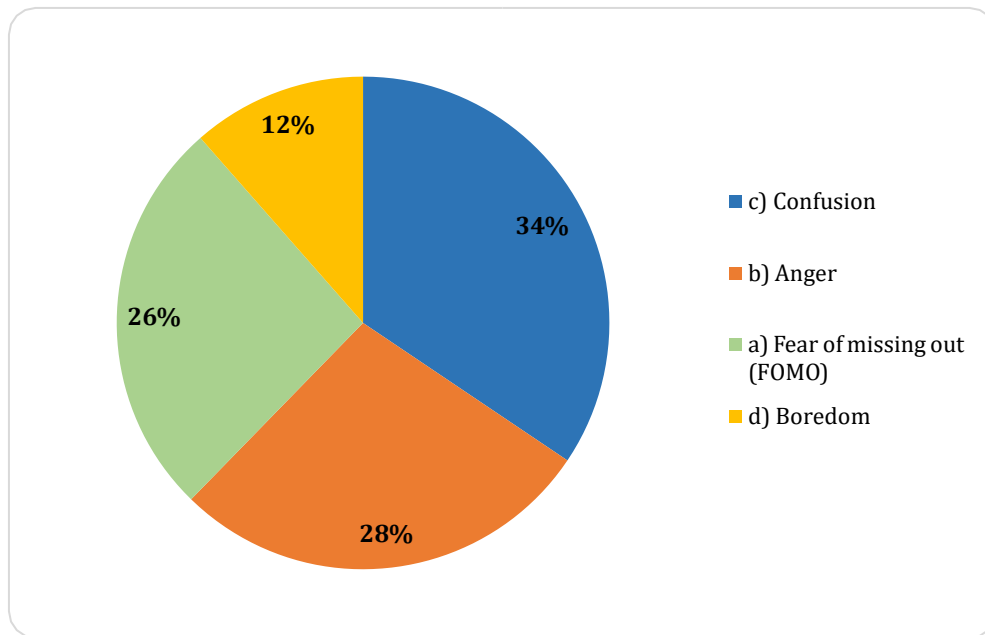
Response	No. of Respondents	Percentage
b) They delay purchase	22	36%
c) Encouraged to buy more	13	21%
d) They switch brands	13	21%
a) They ignore the product	13	21%
Total	61	100%



Interpretation: Responses to BOGO offers were distributed across all options, with 36% indicating they delay their purchase to evaluate, while 21% each said they are encouraged to buy more, switch brands, or ignore the product. This suggests mixed consumer responses to BOGO promotions, pointing to the complexity of consumer psychology around bundled offers.

10. Which psychological factor is triggered by heavy discounts?

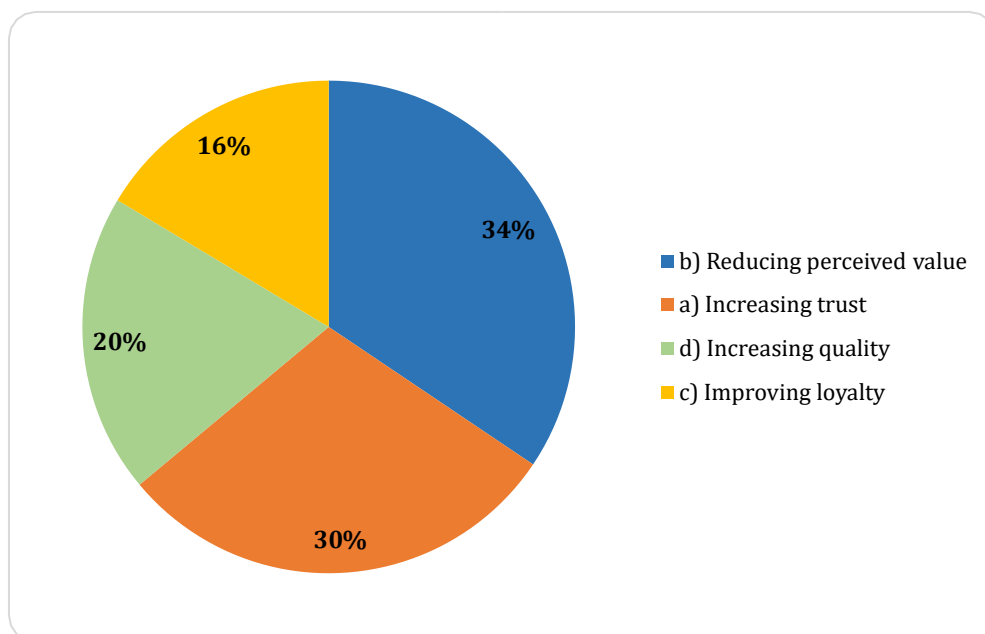
Response	No. of Respondents	Percentage
c) Confusion	21	34%
b) Anger	17	28%
a) Fear of missing out (FOMO)	16	26%
d) Boredom	7	11%
Total	61	100%



Interpretation: 34% of respondents associated heavy discounts with consumer confusion, while 28% cited anger and 26% cited FOMO. Interestingly, FOMO the expected dominant response ranked third, suggesting that excessive or unclear discounting may create confusion and negative emotions rather than positive purchase motivation.

11. Frequent discounts may negatively affect a brand by:

Response	No. of Respondents	Percentage
b) Reducing perceived value	21	34%
a) Increasing trust	18	30%
d) Increasing quality	12	20%
c) Improving loyalty	10	16%
Total	61	100%



Interpretation: 34% of respondents correctly identified reducing perceived value as the primary negative effect of frequent discounts on a brand. Interestingly, 30% believed frequent discounts increase trust, suggesting awareness gaps about the long-term brand equity risks of excessive promotional pricing.

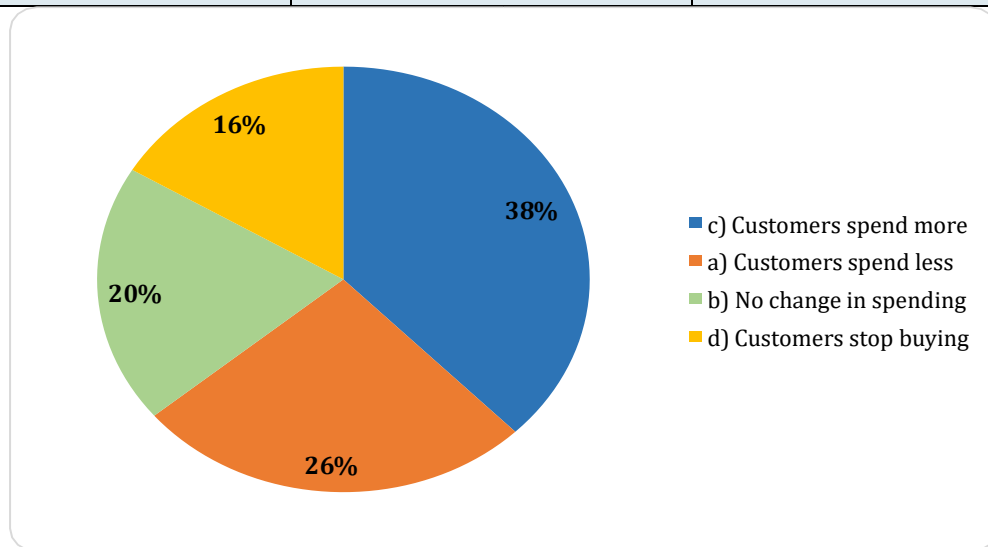
12. Which type of customer is most likely influenced by discounts?

Response	No. of Respondents	Percentage
b) Price-sensitive customers	18	30%
a) Brand-loyal customers	17	28%
c) High-income customers	15	25%
d) Occasional buyers	11	18%
Total	61	100%

Interpretation: Price-sensitive customers were most frequently identified as the primary target of discount influence at 30%, followed closely by brand-loyal (28%) and high-income customers (25%). Occasional buyers accounted for 18%. The near-equal distribution reflects that discounts appeal broadly across multiple customer segments, not exclusively to priceconscious buyers.

13. What is a common result of promotional offers on spending behavior?

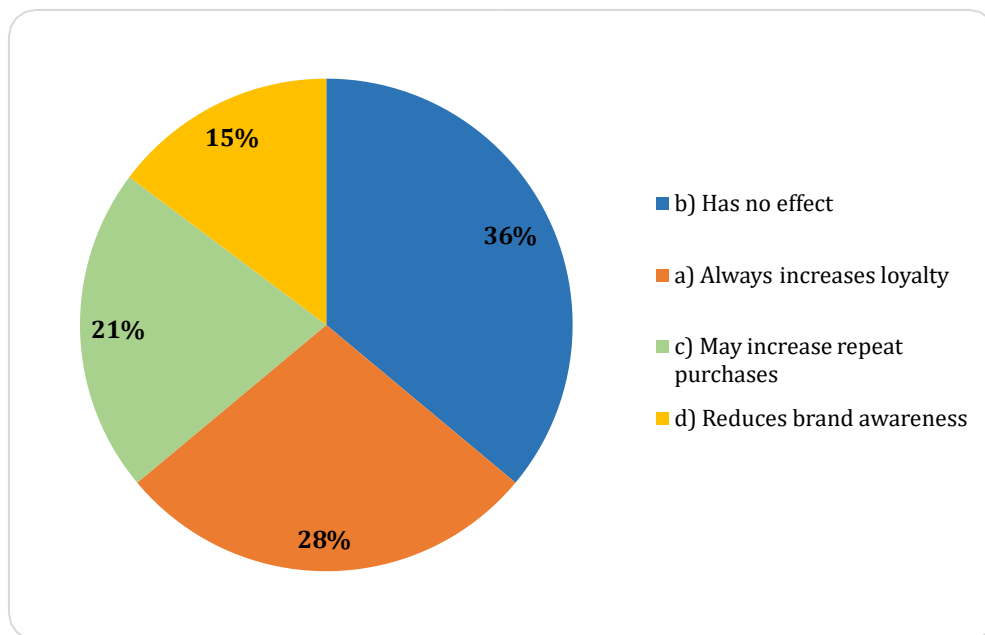
Response	No. of Respondents	Percentage
c) Customers spend more	23	38%
a) Customers spend less	16	26%
b) No change in spending	12	20%
d) Customers stop buying	10	16%
Total	61	100%



Interpretation: 38% of respondents indicated that promotional offers lead customers to spend more, while 26% said customers spend less, 20% reported no change, and 16% said customers stop buying. The plurality response confirms that promotional offers generally stimulate higher spending, though the significant minority suggesting reduced or unchanged spending highlights variability in consumer responses.

14. What is the long-term effect of attractive offers on customer loyalty?

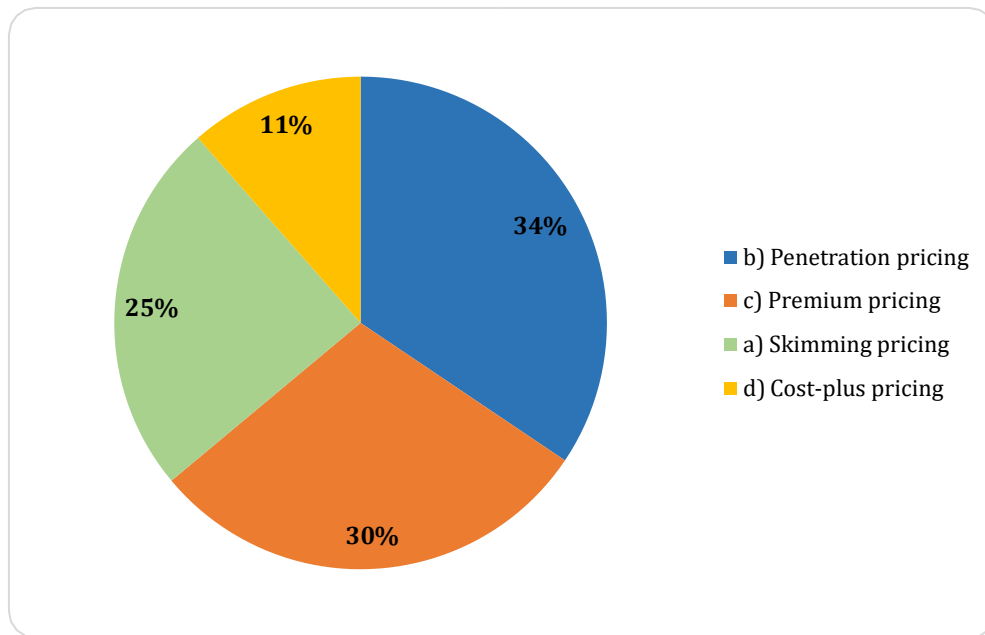
Response	No. of Respondents	Percentage
b) Has no effect	22	36%
a) Always increases loyalty	17	28%
c) May increase repeat purchases	13	21%
d) Reduces brand awareness	9	15%
Total	61	100%



Interpretation: 36% of respondents believed attractive offers have no long-term effect on loyalty, while 28% said they always increase loyalty and 21% said they may increase repeat purchases. This divided response highlights the complexity of the discount-loyalty relationship, suggesting that offers alone do not guarantee long-term customer retention.

15. Which marketing strategy uses discounts to attract new customers?

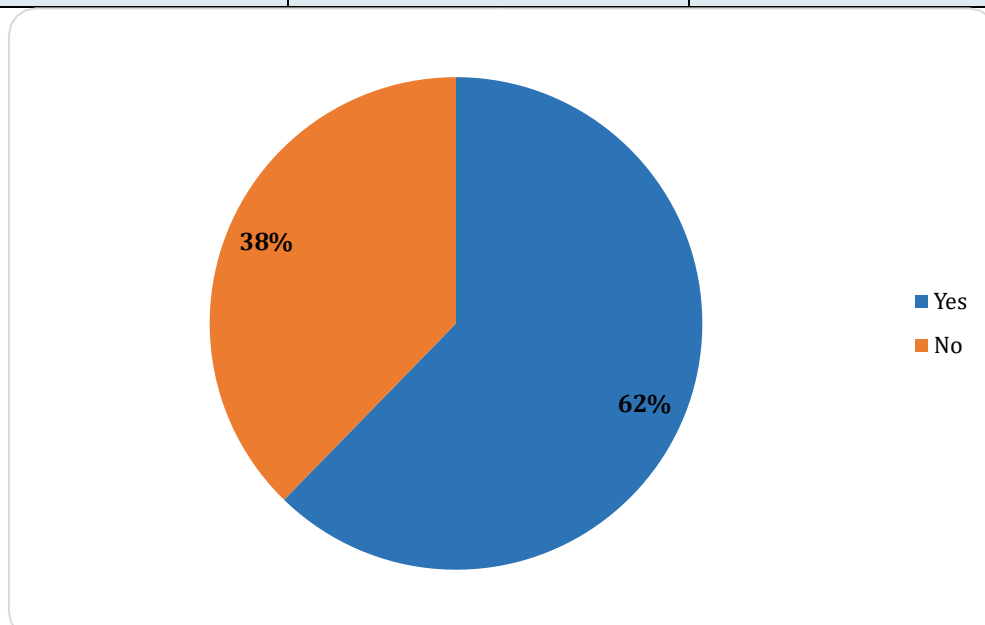
Response	No. of Respondents	Percentage
b) Penetration pricing	21	34%
c) Premium pricing	18	30%
a) Skimming pricing	15	25%
d) Cost-plus pricing	7	11%
Total	61	100%



Interpretation: 34% of respondents identified penetration pricing as the strategy that uses discounts to attract new customers, while 30% selected premium pricing, 25% selected skimming pricing, and 11% selected cost-plus pricing. Penetration pricing correctly dominates as the strategy most explicitly linked to aggressive discount-based market entry.

16. Do you tend to buy more items when special offers are available?

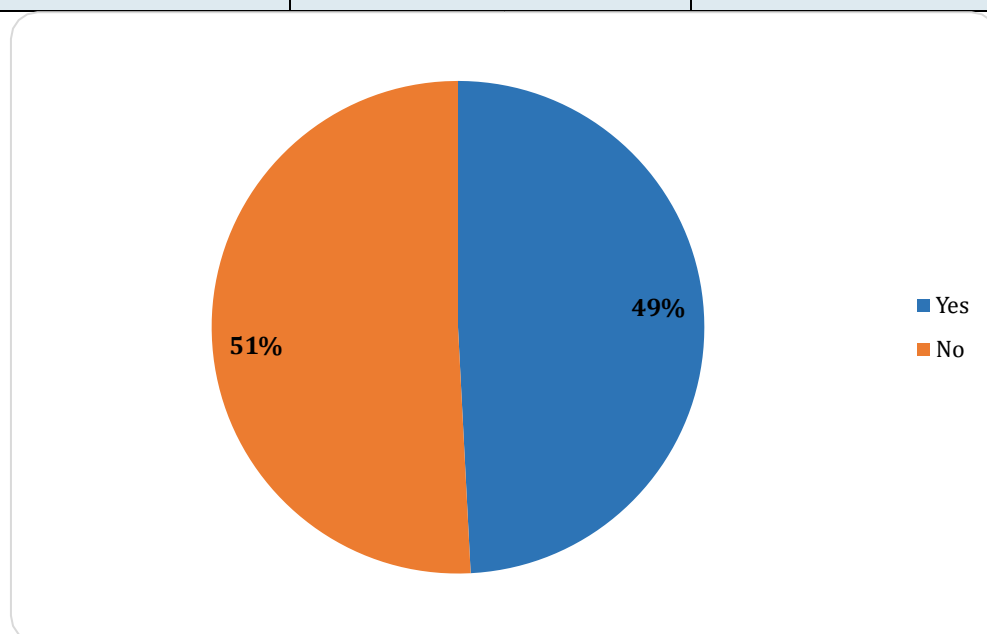
Response	No. of Respondents	Percentage
Yes	38	62%
No	23	38%
Total	61	100%



Interpretation: 62% of respondents confirmed that they buy more items when special offers are available, while 38% do not. This finding validates the widely-held marketing belief that promotional pricing directly increases basket size and purchase quantity, making discount offers a reliable tool for boosting sales volume.

17. Do discounts influence your decision to purchase a product?

Response	No. of Respondents	Percentage
Yes	30	49%
No	31	51%
Total	61	100%

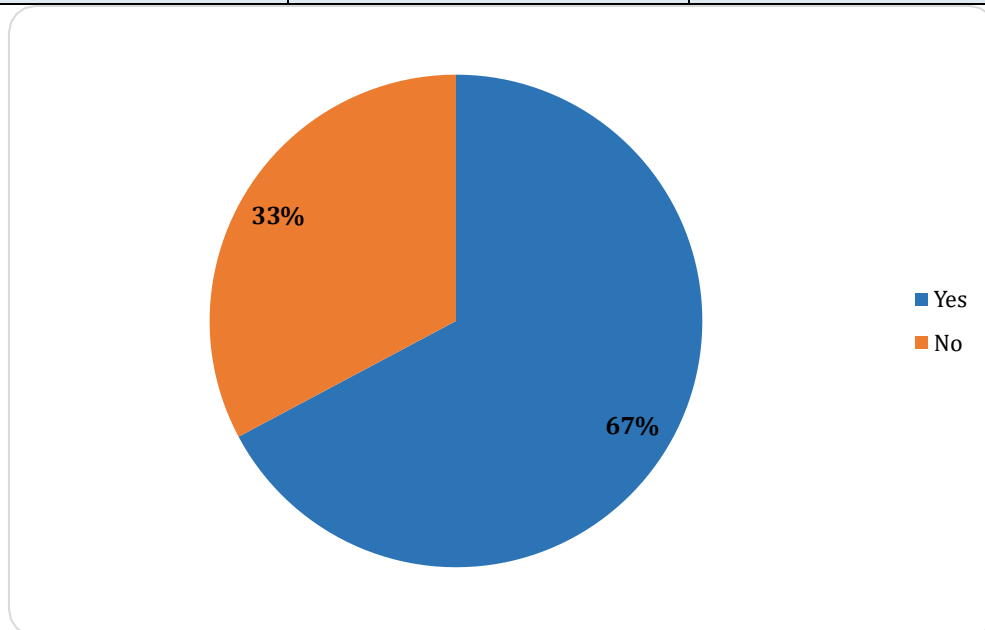


Interpretation: The responses were virtually split, with 49% saying discounts influence their purchase decisions and 51% saying they do not. This near-equal division reveals that while discounts are impactful for approximately half of consumers, a significant segment makes purchase decisions independent of promotional pricing, underscoring the importance of product quality and brand equity alongside discounting.

18. Do limited-time offers encourage you to make quicker purchase decisions?

Response	No. of Respondents	Percentage
Yes	41	67%

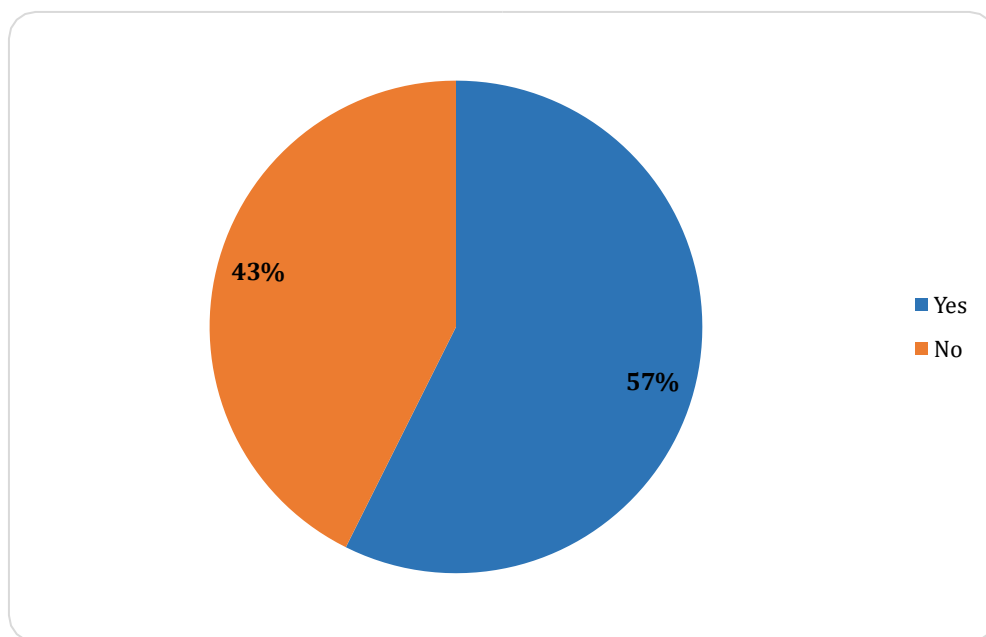
No	20	33%
Total	61	100%



Interpretation: 67% of respondents confirmed that limited-time offers encourage quicker purchase decisions, while 33% said they do not. This is one of the strongest findings in the study, empirically confirming that time scarcity is a highly effective trigger for purchase acceleration across the majority of consumers.

19. Do you prefer shopping from brands that frequently provide discounts?

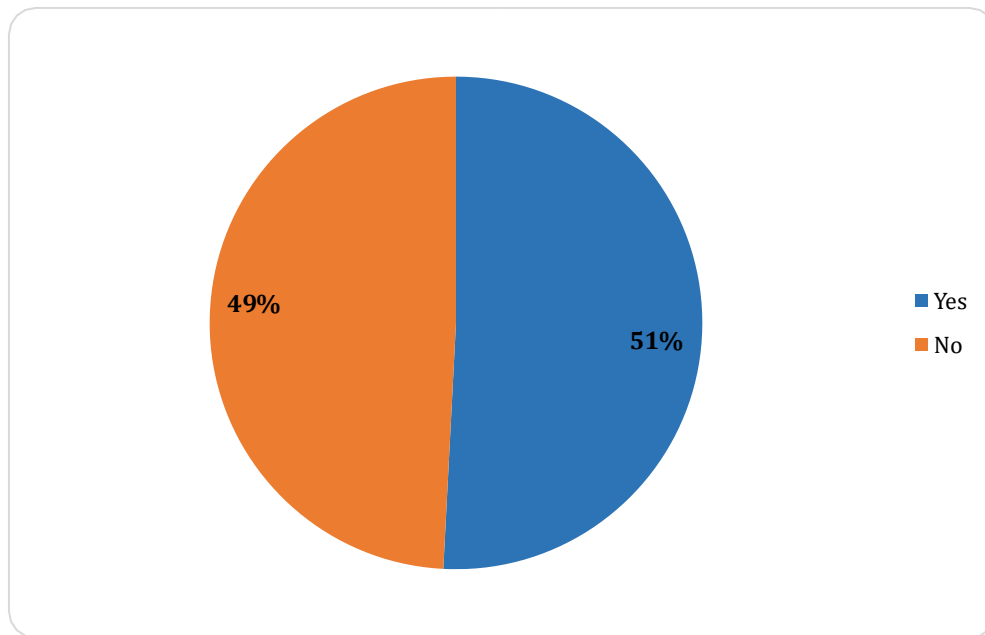
Response	No. of Respondents	Percentage
Yes	35	57%
No	26	43%
Total	61	100%



Interpretation: 57% of respondents prefer shopping from brands that frequently offer discounts, while 43% do not. The majority preference for discount-offering brands indicates that consistent promotional pricing builds a positive brand association among more than half of consumers, though the substantial minority who are indifferent suggests that brand quality and experience also matter significantly.

20. Do discounts make you try new products or brands?

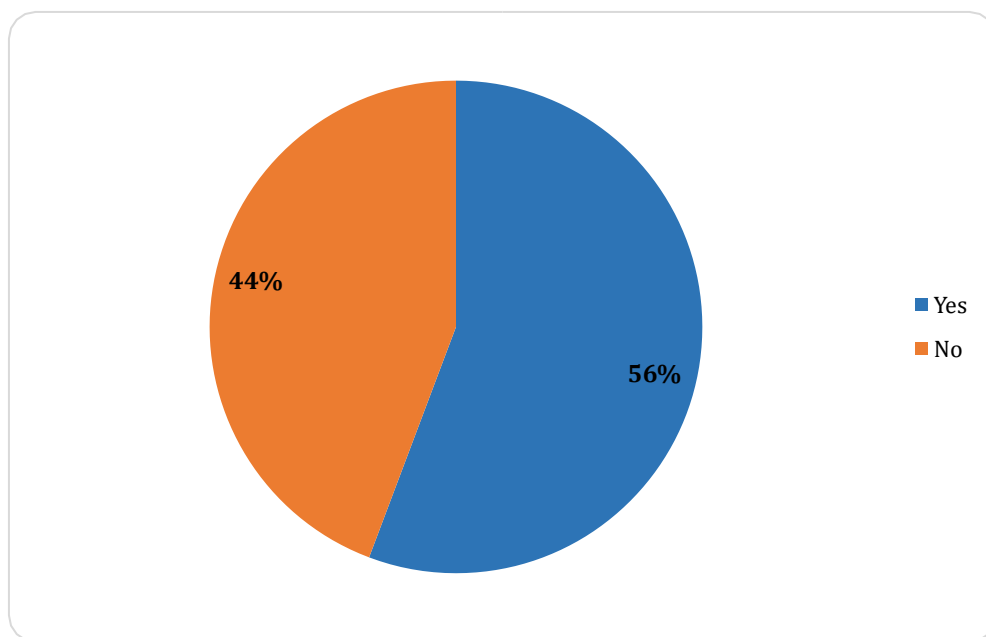
Response	No. of Respondents	Percentage
Yes	31	51%
No	30	49%
Total	61	100%



Interpretation: 51% of respondents confirmed that discounts encourage them to try new products or brands, while 49% said they do not. This near-equal split suggests that while discounts serve as a trial incentive for a slight majority, almost half of consumers are not motivated by price reductions alone to experiment with unfamiliar products or brands.

21. Do you feel satisfied after purchasing products at a discounted price?

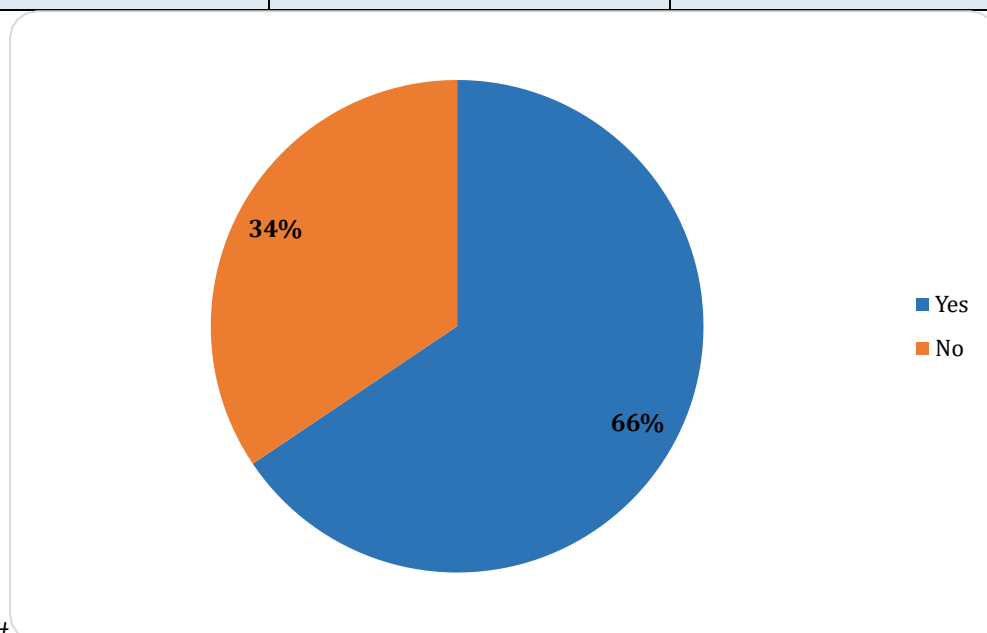
Response	No. of Respondents	Percentage
Yes	34	56%
No	27	44%
Total	61	100%



Interpretation: 56% of respondents reported feeling satisfied after purchasing products at a discounted price, while 44% did not. While a majority report satisfaction, the 44% who do not may reflect concerns about product quality or a sense that discounted purchases do not fully meet their expectations, highlighting the importance of maintaining quality standards alongside promotional pricing.

22. Do promotional offers increase your overall spending?

Response	No. of Respondents	Percentage
Yes	40	66%
No	21	34%
Total	61	100%

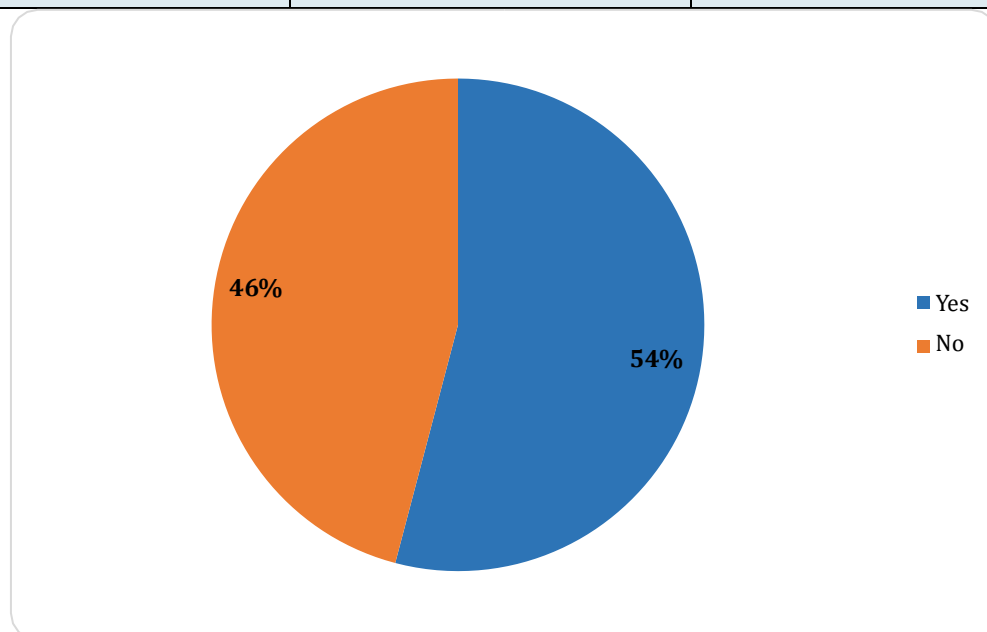


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Interpretation: 66% of respondents confirmed that promotional offers increase their overall spending, while 34% said they do not. This finding provides strong empirical evidence that promotional pricing is an effective revenue driver, with a clear majority of consumers acknowledging spending more when offers are present.

23. Do you compare discounts across different brands before buying?

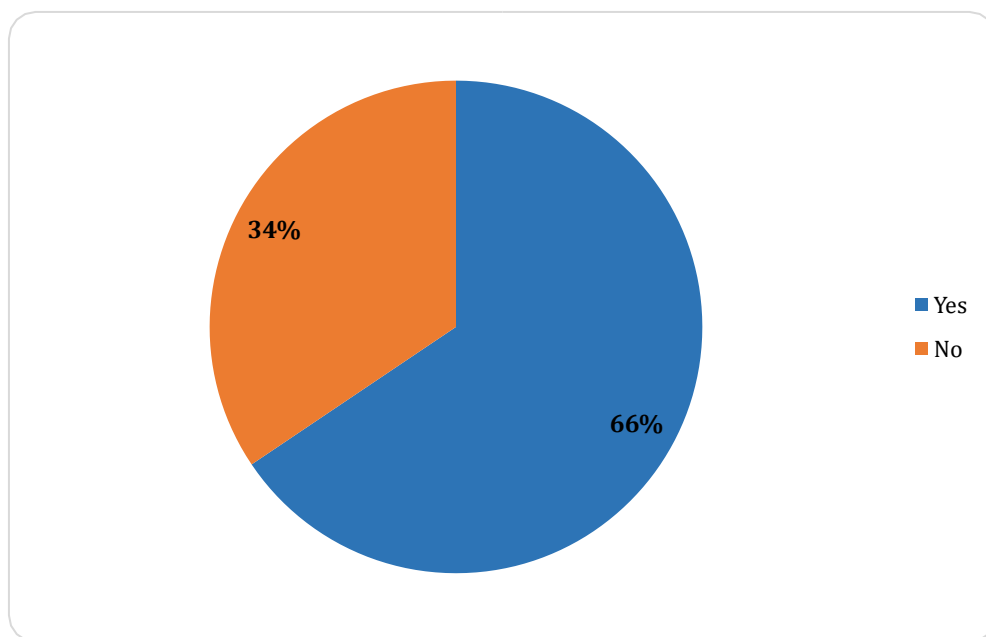
Response	No. of Respondents	Percentage
Yes	33	54%
No	28	46%
Total	61	100%



Interpretation: 54% of respondents compare discounts across brands before making a purchase, while 46% do not. This finding indicates that more than half of consumers engage in comparative shopping behaviour when discounts are involved, which intensifies competitive pressure and suggests that brands must offer compelling and visible promotions to win price-conscious consumers.

24. Do discounts affect your perception of product quality?

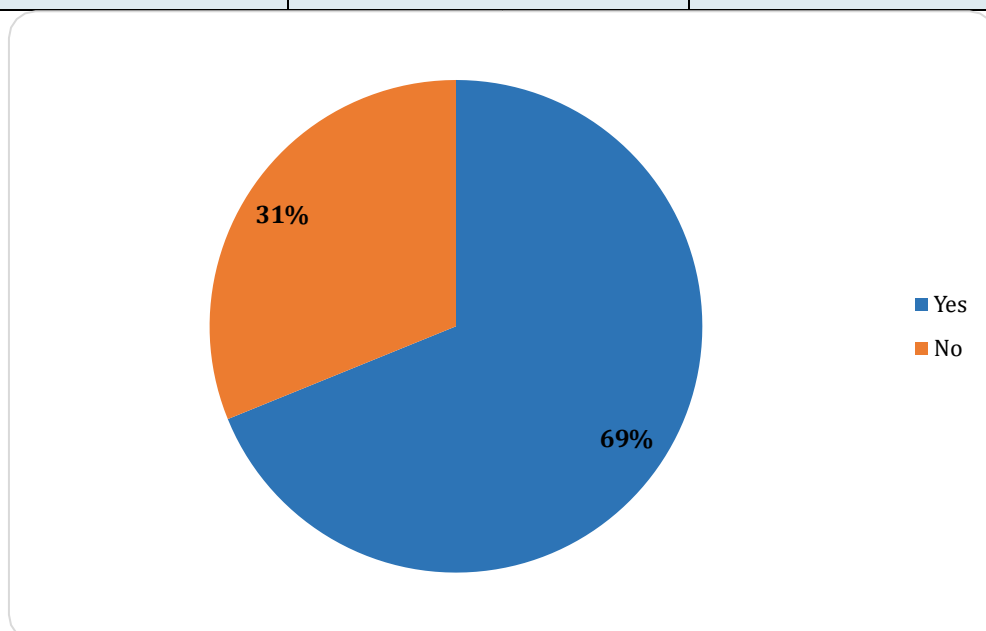
Yes	40	66%
No	21	34%
Total	61	100%



Interpretation: 66% of respondents agreed that discounts affect their perception of product quality, while 34% said they do not. This is a critical finding a significant majority of consumers associate discounting with quality concerns, suggesting that aggressive pricing strategies carry a real risk of undermining the perceived quality and premium positioning of a brand.

25. Do you wait for sales or offers before making a purchase?

Response	No. of Respondents	Percentage
Yes	42	69%
No	19	31%
Total	61	100%



Interpretation: 69% of respondents wait for sales or offers before making purchases, while only 31% do not. This is the strongest behavioural finding in the study, indicating that a large majority of consumers have developed a habitual pattern of deferring purchases until promotional events occur, which has significant implications for demand timing and revenue forecasting for businesses.

4.2 Key Findings of the Study

Based on the analysis of 61 responses collected through a structured Google Forms questionnaire, the following key findings were identified:

The study reveals that discounts are highly effective drivers of consumer purchase intention across multiple dimensions. 80% of respondents agreed that discounts encourage unplanned purchases, and 75% confirmed that limited-time offers create urgency in purchase decisionmaking. Together, these findings establish discounts as powerful triggers for both impulse buying and accelerated decision-making.

Behaviourally, 69% of respondents habitually wait for sales before making purchases the strongest single behavioural indicator in the study. 67% make quicker decisions under limited-time offers, 66% report increased overall spending under promotions, and 62% buy more items when offers are available. These four findings collectively confirm that discounts have a strong and consistent positive effect on purchase quantity and timing.

However, the study also reveals important nuances. 66% of respondents report that discounts affect their perception of product quality suggesting significant quality signal risk from aggressive pricing. Additionally, the near-equal split on whether discounts directly influence purchase decisions (49% Yes vs. 51% No) and whether discounts drive new product trials (51% vs. 49%) highlights considerable individual variability in discount responsiveness.

4.4 Summary of Data Analysis

The data collected from 61 respondents through a structured Google Forms questionnaire provides a comprehensive and multi-dimensional picture of how discounts and promotional offers influence consumer purchase intention.

The attitudinal analysis (Q1-Q5) consistently shows majority agreement that discounts drive purchasing behaviour, with endorsement rates ranging from 64% (spending more under discounts) to 80% (unplanned purchases). The average agreement rate across the five attitudinal statements is 72%, confirming strong overall positive attitudinal response to discount strategies.

The knowledge and perception analysis (Q6-Q15) reveals that consumers are broadly aware of the mechanisms of discount psychology. Lower price (38%) and limited-time framing (41%) are correctly identified as the dominant drivers of discount attraction and urgency respectively. Notably, 34% of respondents correctly identified penetration pricing as the strategy that uses discounts to attract new customers.

The behavioural analysis (Q16-Q25) provides the most actionable insights. The highest behavioural endorsement is for waiting for sales before purchasing (69%), followed by making quicker decisions under limited-time offers (67%), increased overall spending (66%), and quality perception effects (66%). The lowest endorsements are for direct purchase decision influence (49%) and new product trials (51%), suggesting that discounts are more effective at accelerating existing purchase intentions than creating entirely new ones.

5. FINDINGS AND DISCUSSION

The findings of this study offer important and practical insights into how discounts affect consumer purchase intentions. The key discovery is that discounts work through various psychological pathways at the same time. They increase perceived value, create urgency through limited availability, trigger loss aversion, and allow consumers to showcase smart buying habits. This multifaceted influence explains why discounts are consistently effective marketing tools across different product categories and consumer groups.

The strong support for limited-time offers as creators of urgency—75% agreement in attitudes and 67% confirmation in behavior—fits well with Cialdini's (2001) principle of scarcity and Kahneman and Tversky's (1979) loss aversion theory. Consumers seem to respond keenly to the idea of scarcity, which makes time-limited promotions particularly powerful for marketers.

The fact that 69% of consumers regularly wait for sales before making a purchase is significant for business planning. This suggests that regular discount strategies might be training consumers to delay purchases, potentially hurting full-price sales and creating predictable demand dips between promotional periods. Businesses need to assess whether their promotional schedules are fostering a dependence on discounts among their customers.

The finding that 66% of consumers believe discounts affect their perception of product quality is especially important for strategic planning. It confirms the concern that aggressive or frequent discounting can harm brand value, particularly for brands in premium or aspirational markets. This result strongly supports the idea of using discounts selectively and strategically, rather than relying on constant or indiscriminate promotional pricing.

6. CONCLUSION

The findings of this study, based on responses from 61 participants through a detailed questionnaire, show that discounts and promotional offers significantly affect consumer purchase intention.

At the attitudinal level, the average agreement rate of 72% across five key statements confirms that discounts positively influence consumer feelings about products, brands, and when to buy. At the behavioral level, 69% of respondents wait for sales, 67% make quicker decisions during limited-time offers, and 66% spend more when promotions are available. These results indicate that discount strategies turn positive attitudes into real purchasing actions.

However, the study also raises important concerns. Sixty-six percent report that discounts affect how they perceive quality, while 34% feel confused or experience negative emotions due to heavy discounting. This highlights the risks of poorly executed promotional strategies. Discounts can be a double-edged sword that drives short-term sales while threatening brand equity and consumer perceptions of quality.

In conclusion, the best discount strategy is selective, time-limited, clearly communicated, and fits the brand's positioning. Businesses that view discounts as a strategic tool instead of a quick fix are more likely to drive short-term purchase intention while also building lasting brand loyalty and consumer trust in the long run.

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